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The only time we're in the front is when it's time to die.



Black GIs were "cannon fodder" in the U.S. war of aggression in Vietnam. Carter's "pardon" has been denounced by Black veterans organizations because it did not deal with a huge number of ex-servicemen (nearly 800,000) with less-than-honorable discharges.

(Washington, D.C.) - Black veterans organizations and other veterans groups representing poor and minority people across the country have denounced President Jimmy Carter's "pardon" of Vietnam era draft evaders because of its exclusion of veterans with less-than-honorable discharges — who are overwhelmingly Black, Chicano, Puerto Rican Native Americans and poor Whites.

The American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU) said in a statement that the pardon "extends overdue relief to a small segment of the war resisters of the Vietnam era, but military offenders and veterans with less-than-honorable discharges are more numerous than draft violators by a factor of 100 to 1. They are also, by and large, more likely to be poor, from minority groups and less educated." ACLU Executive Director Aryeh Neier added that "99 per cent of the people who could have benefited from a full amnesty still need to be dealt with," the *New York Times* reports.

A recent study on draft resistance in the Vietnam era, commissioned by the University of Notre Dame and researched by Lawrence M. Baskir and William A. Strauss, declares, "The burdens of Vietnam were unevenly imposed. The economically and socially disadvantaged did most of the fighting. They also paid most of the penalties for not fighting. No one should be asked to pay any further price."

During last fall's Presidential campaign, Carter promised that, if elected, he would pardon all those who broke Selective Service laws during the Vietnam War, in an effort to "heal our country. . ." However, the pardon —

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